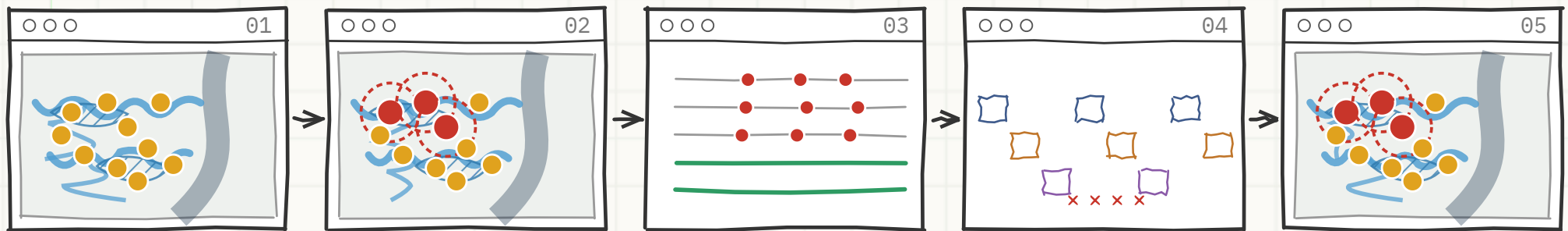


WHO OWNS THE FLOOD? • THE FLOW

Wireframes v1 • for discussion • Wandile Mthiyane • Harvard GSD MDE

The viewer scrolls through 7 states in 5 frames. Each frame adds one layer to the last.



01 Water → People

map + layers

Where does the water go? Where did we put people?

02 The return

floods + timeline

What happens when they flood again?

03 World → Control

world timelines

Only here? What's different elsewhere?

04 Answers → System

cards → chain

Don't care? Poor? Or no owner?

05 Reveal

map + system

Nobody owned the whole outcome.

PLACE

PATTERN

WORLD + TEST

CAUSE

CLARITY →

WHAT THE VIEWER DOES

Scrolls. Each scroll adds one layer. No clicking needed.

HOW THE STORY BUILDS

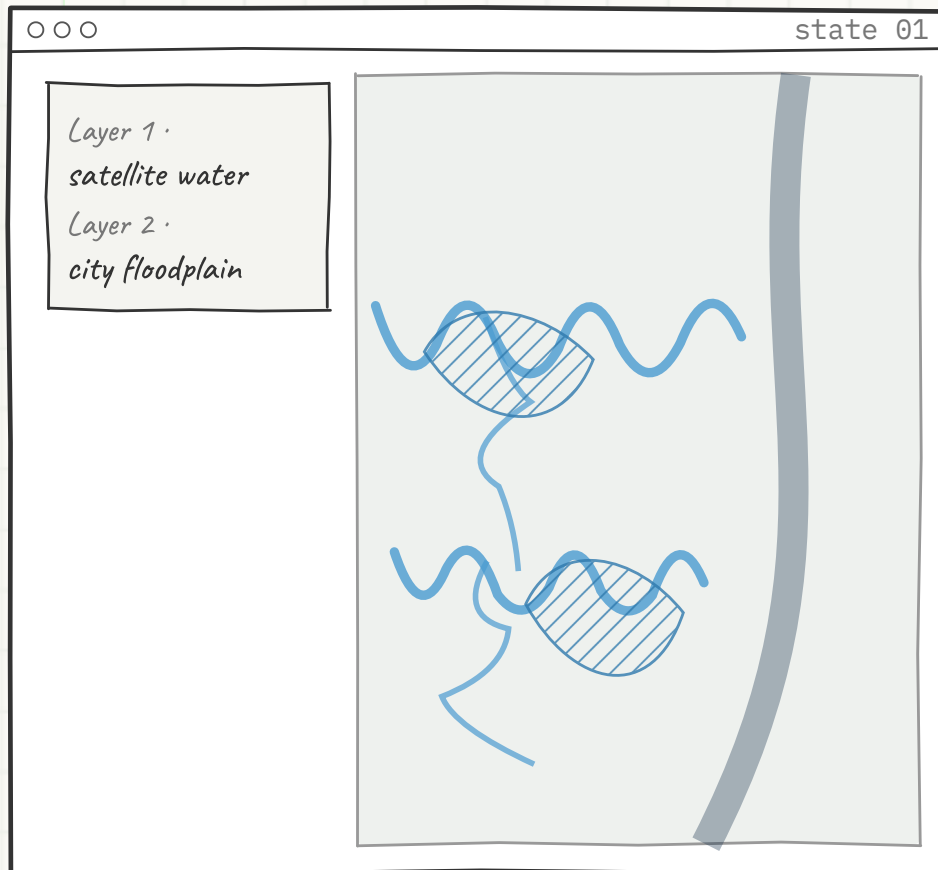
A place, then a pattern, then the world, then a test, then the cause.

WHAT THEY LEAVE WITH

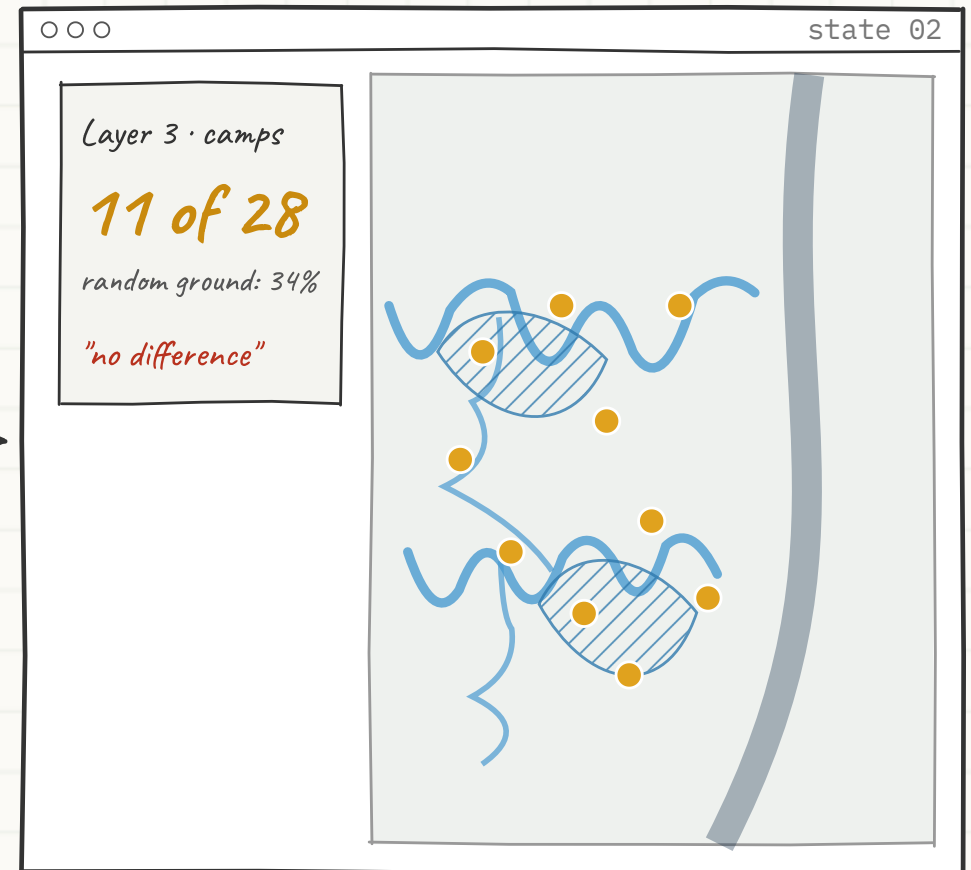
"The information existed. Nobody owned the outcome."

01 · WATER → PEOPLE

Where does the water go? Where did we put people?



scroll
→



bright blue = floods and dries; hatched = the city's 1:100 map

camps drop in one by one; counter ticks up

SEES FIRST

Durban from space. Satellite water, then the city's own floodplain.

WHAT CHANGES

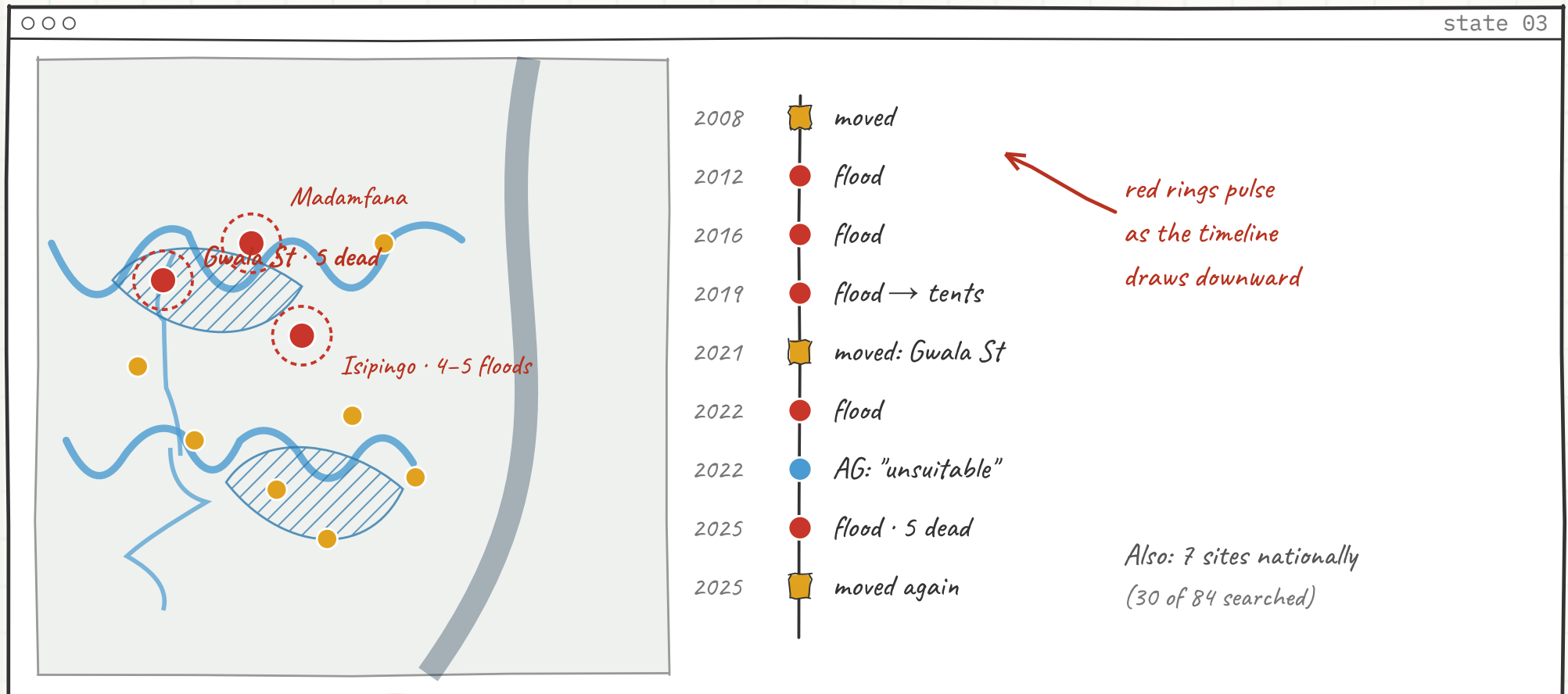
Scroll: 28 amber camps drop onto the map. A stat card counts them.

TAKEAWAY

Camps land on flood ground about as often as chance (39% vs 34%). The map made no difference.

02 • THE RETURN

What happens when the people we moved flood again?



SEES

The same map. The water pulses back over 3 camps.

WHAT CHANGES

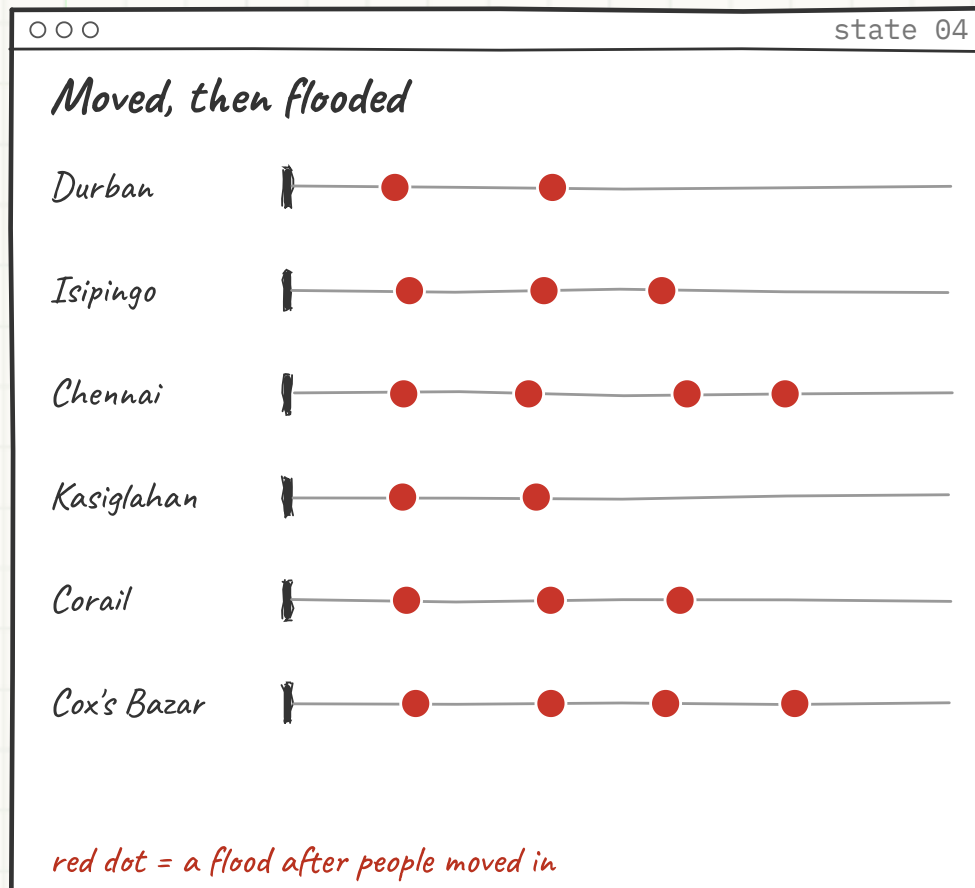
A timeline builds beside it: moved, flooded, moved, flooded, 5 dead.

TAKEAWAY

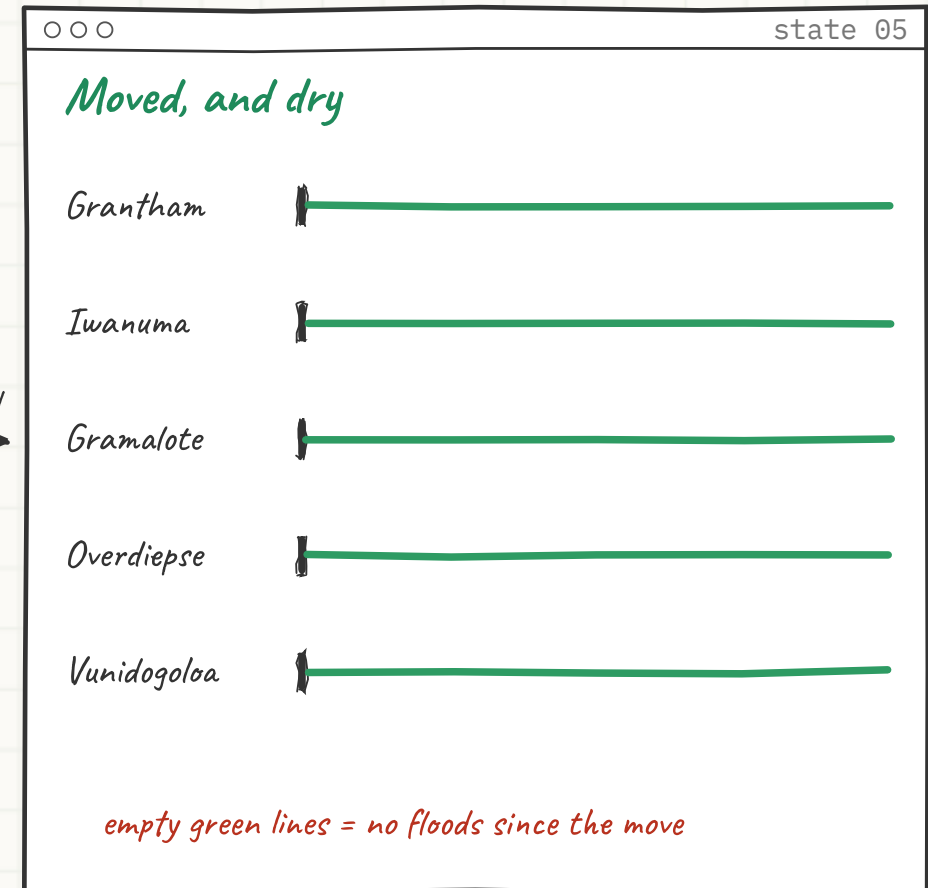
It isn't one bad flood. It's a loop along the same river.

03 · COMPARISON → CONTROL GROUP

Is this uniquely South African? So what is different?



scroll
→



SEES

Zoom out: timelines of relocation sites worldwide.
Red dots are floods after the move.

WHAT CHANGES

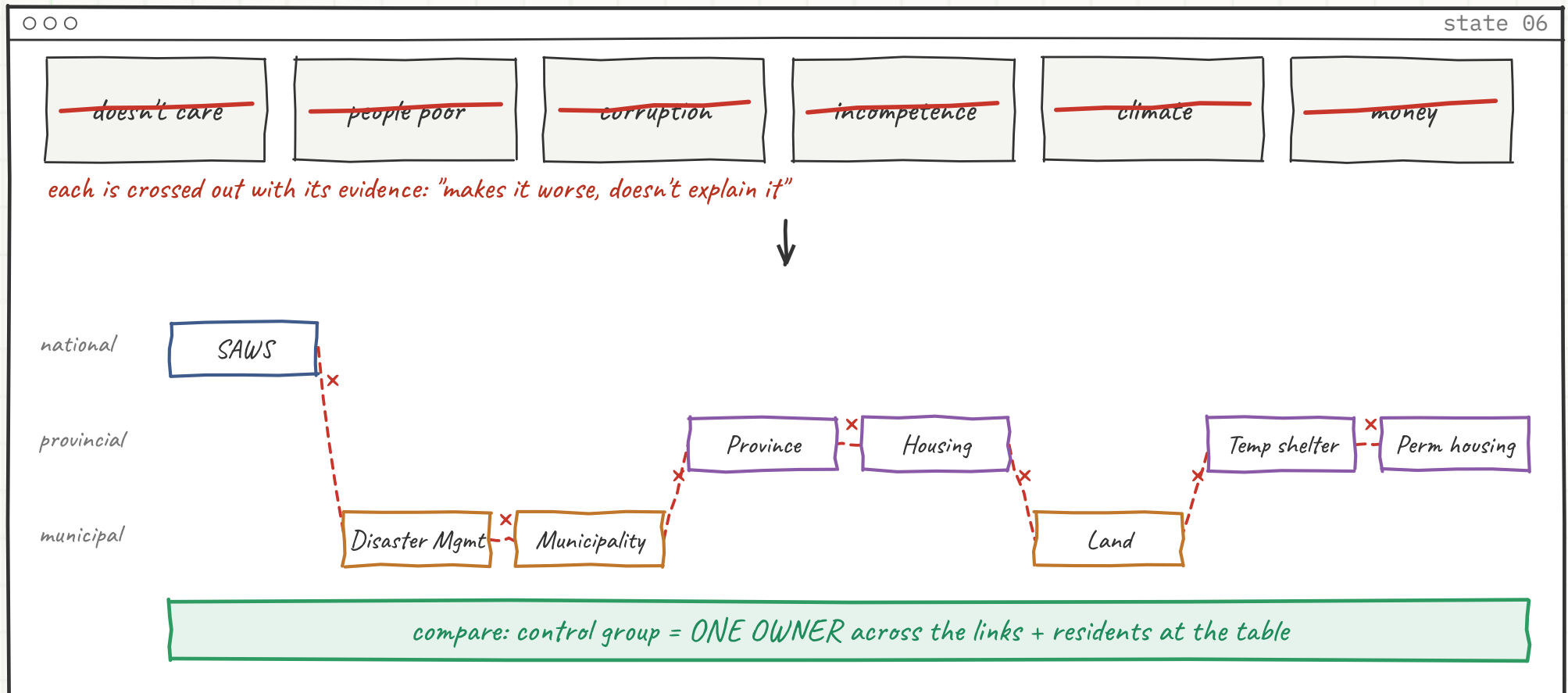
Scroll: the control group slides in. Green lines, no dots.

TAKEAWAY

Same rain, different outcome. Something in how they're run differs.

04 · THE USUAL ANSWERS → THE SYSTEMS

Is it that they don't care? That people are poor?



SEES

Six "usual answers" as cards. Each is crossed out, with its evidence.

WHAT CHANGES

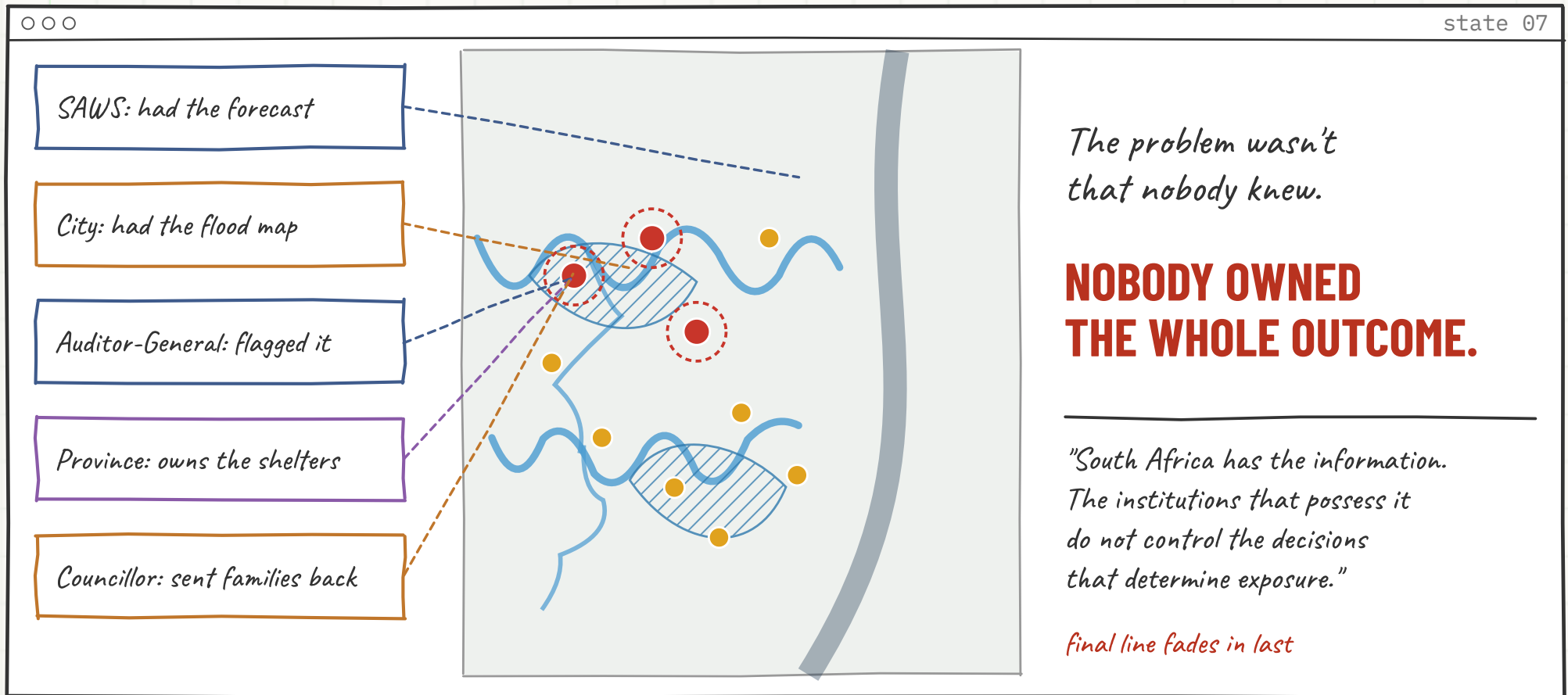
The cards clear. South Africa's chain draws itself: 8 links, 3 spheres, x at every hand-off.

TAKEAWAY

Different institutions, budgets and authority. No end-to-end owner.

05 • THE REVEAL

The problem wasn't that nobody knew.



SEES

The first map returns, with the system drawn over it.

WHAT CHANGES

Each holder of information lights up: forecast, flood map, audit, shelters. None is connected to the camp.

TAKEAWAY

"South Africa has the information. The institutions that possess it do not control the decisions that determine exposure."